



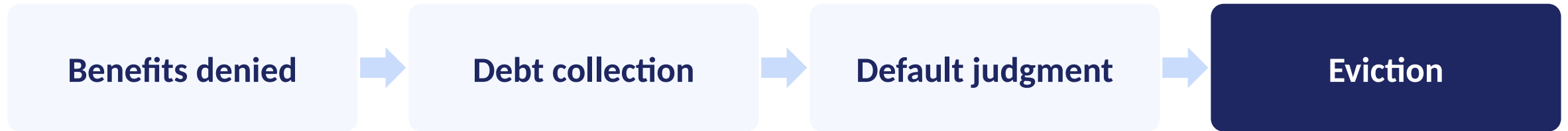
Civil Justice as Code

Look up, encode, validate & share the law

Free legal help at scale, for the millions of Americans who can't afford a lawyer

Andrew M. Cohen, Esq. · Former CLO · Board Member, Bay Area Legal Aid · Apache-2.0 open source

The Access to Justice Crisis – 30 million Americans face civil legal problems without a lawyer – and the problems cascade:



AI predicts, but why predict what the statute of limitations is when you can look it up and determine it?

PREDICT

“The limitations period is probably three years.”

LOOK UP

“CCP §338: 3 years. Verified today.”

Notice periods · day counts · service methods · deadlines — deterministic rules decide these cases

Two barriers to adoption of AI for legal (and one barrier just fell).



Lack of Coordination / Lack of Infrastructure

One-off AI pilots by state. But as of 2026: AI platforms offer shared legal infrastructure



Lack of Trust

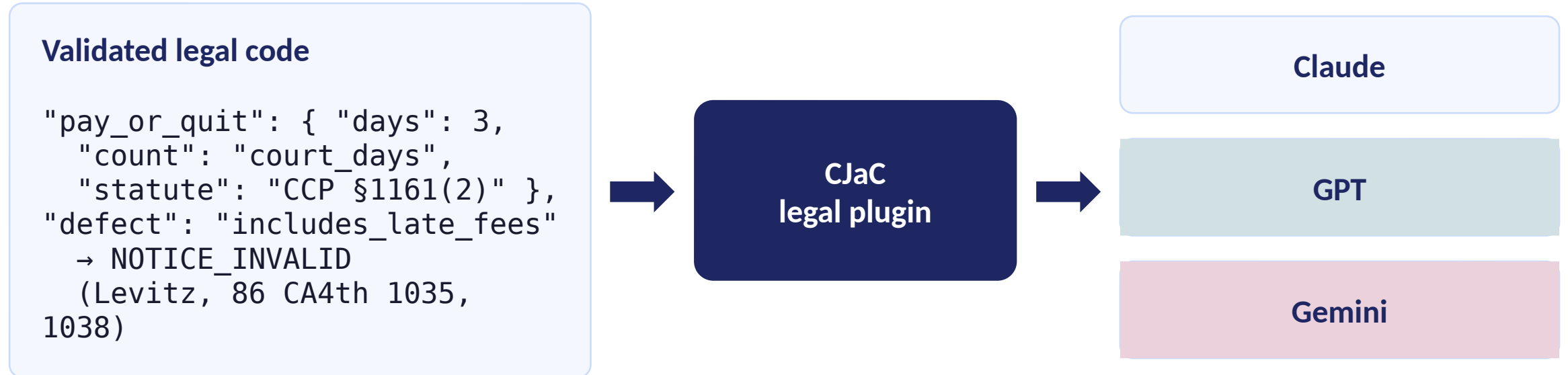
AI can seem like a black box.

Rather than asking AI to predict a legal answer, CJaC leverages AI proactively to look up, encode, validate and share the law



Humans direct. AI executes. Attorneys are named as responsible.

The civil justice law is codified, validated and “plugged-in” to the AI models



Used by legal-aid & court workers — and the public — inside the AI interface they already have

Model-agnostic by design. Open source (Apache-2.0). No lock-in.

Validated like enterprise software



Multi-model AI review



Attorney-frozen golden-set testing



Continuous currency & improvement — built into the process



A named attorney on every determination



NIST-aligned, open source, hash-verified

Why CJaC is needed — even as AI improves



Lookup beats prediction



Verifiability (vs black box)



Currency & iteration



Improves with model progress

Not “how good is AI on average” — “is this answer verified and current?”

First testing & validation cycle: successful — and published

July 2026 • California eviction notices • attorney-frozen test set • dual-model consensus

Errors surfaced & corrected

on both the machine and human sides

Verified the code

by the named attorney, regression-verified

Published

methodology, scores, hashes — all public

Error-correction machinery

The ask

For AI model providers

Legal-plugin team introduction

Review our code — and if it's good enough, marketplace placement

Strategic advice & amplification

Free legal-help plugins no one has a financial incentive to build. Thirty minutes to explore it.

The ask

For law schools & the A2J community

Clinic partnership — testing & legal review

Volunteer reviewers from the A2J community

Longer term: adopt and steward the project

Students learn the law by encoding it — and the encoded law helps people the day it ships.

Free, validated legal help — for the millions who can't afford it.

Look up, encode, validate & share the law